

White Sox Send Tribe Pitcher and a Giant First Baseman

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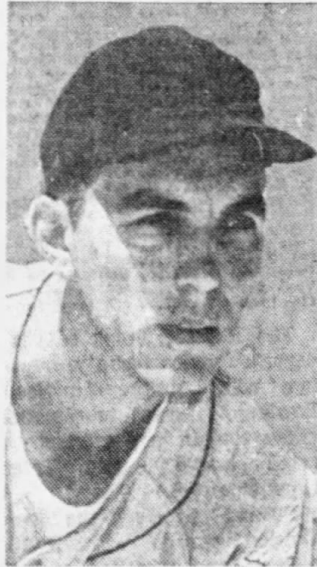
HOLLYWOOD, Fla.—More talent was heading for Manager Andy Cohen today with the announcement that the Chicago White Sox are optioning Ron Jackson, giant first baseman, and Don Rudolph, southpaw pitcher, to the Indianapolis Indians.

Both were expected here today and both should be welcome additions to the Indianapolis roster. In Jackson, the Indians are receiving one of the tallest players ever to wear Indianapolis colors. The 6.7 giant bats and throws right-handed and figures to fill the Tribe's first-base vacancy.

Jackson, a graduate of Western Michigan College, was signed by the White Sox as a bonus player in June of 1954. He appeared in 40 games with the Chicago that year, batting .280. In '55 Jackson also played in 40 games with the White Sox and batted .203.

The 23-year-old native of Kalamazoo, Mich., opened the '56 season with Chicago and remained until June 15 when his two-year bonus tenure expired. He was optioned to Vancouver in the Pacific Coast League where he batted .304 in 82 games and collected nine homers, five triples, 15 doubles while batting in 49 runs. "Jackson is a great-looking hitter," said Tribe President Ownie Bush, "and one who will hit a ball harder or farther. We've been wanting a strong right-handed batter, and I think Jackson will be the answer."

Marty Marion, former White Sox manager, once said of

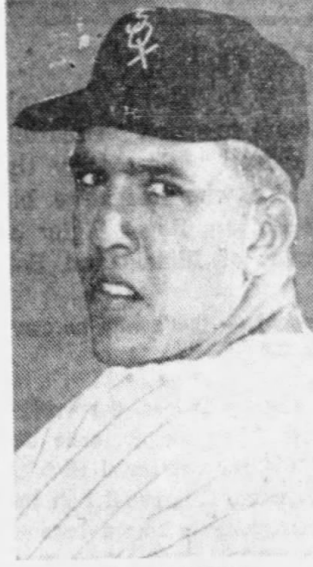


DON RUDOLPH
Club's Second Lefty

Jackson: "I've never seen anyone hit a ball harder. I don't mean just the home runs. I mean those shots which whistle on a line like bullets."

Rudolph, whose wife is a burlesque performer under the name of Patti Waggin, will have an excellent opportunity with Indianapolis, mainly because he's left-handed. As of now, the Indians have only one southpaw, Rodolfo Arias, and its doubtful whether he can make the grade.

But Rudolph has other things in his favor. At Memphis last year he won 11 and lost 10. However, he showed a 3.19 earned-run average, second best in the league. That's rather impressive in view of the "rabbit" ball used in the Southern Association.



RON JACKSON
6.7, Bat to Match

The 25-year-old native of Baltimore was pitching in the all-American tournament in Rhode Island when spotted by the White Sox. In his first year at Jessup, Ga., Rudolph won 13 games.

The next year, 1951, he became the winningest pitcher in baseball with a 28-8 record and a 2.91 ERA at Jessup. The following season the southpaw was at Colorado Springs, under Don Gutteridge, former Indianapolis manager and currently a Chisox coach.

A 2-year stretch in military service interrupted Don's baseball career and when he came back to the Colorado club in 1954 he could win only nine while losing 14. He was 3 and 2 the following year at Memphis. In 182 innings with the Chicks last season, Rudolph

yielded only 52 bases on balls and 163 hits. He fanned 83.

"I guess the bubble burst," was Manager Cohen's dry comment after the Indians took an 8-3 licking from Buffalo yesterday to end a five-game winning streak. "Their hitters are looking better and our young pitching is beginning to level off."

BIG LUKE HAS HIS SAY

Just then Luke Easter strolled by on his way to the Buffalo bus.

"You wuz winnin' too many," laughed the big slugger. "That ain't good. You gotta' lose once awhile, an' when youse lose, you can start winnin' again."

Wayne Sperry, the California beanpole who looked so good on his first outing, was wild yesterday and his mates were just as erratic. Three hits, three walks, a hit batsman, a wild pitch and two errors gave the Bisons 7 runs in the fourth and that was the game.

Bob Hall, bought on a look-see basis from San Diego, pitched three perfect innings as the starter. He's had a sore arm this spring. Hall spent a month in the American Association with Milwaukee in 1951 and he recalls a particularly good day at Indianapolis.

"It was a bitter cold night," recalls Hall, "but I was hot at the plate. I hit a home run, two doubles and a single to beat you about 14 to something. Never had a night at the plate like that before or after."